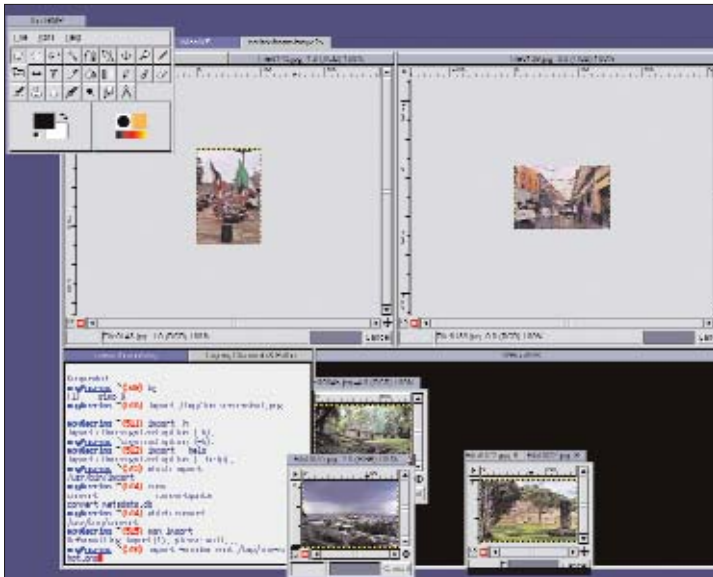


bloated with software that is forced on the user, which appeals to the Linux philosophy of customisation. This means if a user prefers f-spot (GNOME) instead of Gwenview (KDE) and Amarok (KDE) instead of Rhythmbox (GNOME), the user is free to install these software without having to uninstall competing programs, or keep two programs that serve the same purpose. XFCE is more stable than both Gnome and KDE, and includes a number of special effects like shading and windows animations. A number of respected distros use XFCE, including Slackware, Debian XFCE, dyne:bolic, Xubuntu and Linux Mint.

Other desktop environments



The Desktop Environments listed here are not as widespread or mature as the desktop environments discussed above, but they are all considerably lightweight, some smaller than XFCE as well. This is mostly because a lack of bundled software, but that is not really a problem as most people would want to choose the software for their needs according to individual requirements and preferences. Etch is a desktop environment that stands out in terms of customisability. It does not take anything for granted, and you can represent almost anything you want on the desktop in your own way.